

QUANTITY SURVEYING PRACTICE TRAINING

A Comprehensive Professional Training Program

Module 01: General

Module 02: Main Contractor

Module 03: Consultant &
Client

Module 04: Interview



Empowering Built Environment Professionals

QUANTITY SURVEYING

PRACTICE TRAINING

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ABOUT ACL ACADEMY

WHO WE ARE

ACL Academy is a modern training platform dedicated to developing industry-ready professionals through practical, real-world learning in construction and the built environment. Founded by a Chartered professional with extensive Middle East experience, ACL Academy bridges the gap between academic knowledge and industry practice through hands-on training, real project scenarios, and digital workflows.

OUR VISION

To become a leading global platform that transforms built environment professionals by integrating real industry practice with advanced digital and AI-driven solutions.

OUR MISSION

To equip students and professionals with practical, job-ready skills across the built environment by delivering training that reflects real project environments, enhanced with modern tools, digital workflows, and Artificial Intelligence.

WHY CHOOSE ACL ACADEMY?

Industry Experts in the Lecture Room

Every module is delivered by active construction professionals with real world experience — not academics reading from textbooks.

Practical, Project-Based Learning

You work through real documents, real BOQs, real payment applications and real contract scenarios drawn from live construction projects.

Specific Contract Knowledge

Full coverage of FIDIC, NEC and JCT contracts, procurement practices, and the commercial structures used by leading regional developers.

Interview & Career Preparation

The programme concludes with dedicated interview coaching and a live mock interview session - so you leave job-ready, not just course-complete.

RICS-Aligned Training Standards

Course content, competency framework, and assessment approach are designed to align with RICS professional standards and APC competency requirements.

Trusted by Professionals Across the Gulf

Our graduates are working as QS professionals across the UAE, Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Kuwait, Bahrain, Oman, and Sri Lanka.

MEET YOUR LECTURER



AFRATH MAHMOOD

MRICS, MAIQS, CQS

Senior Cost and Commercial Manager

Saudi Arabia

MSc in Construction Project Management

BSc (Hons) in Quantity Surveying

HND in Civil Engineering (SLIATE)

14+

Yrs Exp

4

Countries

MRICS

Chartered

ABOUT THE LECTURER

Afrath Mahmood is an accomplished, RICS-chartered commercial professional with over 14 years of elite industry experience spanning Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, and Sri Lanka. Currently driving high-value commercial strategies for one of Saudi Arabia's leading real estate developers, Afrath brings a wealth of practical, cutting-edge expertise to the lecture room.

Throughout his distinguished career, he has mastered the complexities of both pre- and post-contract administration, commercial management, value engineering, and project estimation. As an active RICS mentor, Afrath bridges the gap between complex contract theory and real-world executive execution, equipping the next generation of Quantity Surveyors with the exact skills required to navigate today's booming construction landscape.

KEY AREAS OF EXPERTISE

◆ Pre & Post Contract Administration

◆ Commercial Management

◆ Value Engineering

◆ Project Estimation

◆ RICS APC Mentoring

◆ Contract Administration

◆ Cost Control & Reporting

◆ Gulf Construction Markets



ABOUT THIS TRAINING

Quantity Surveying Practice

Bridging the Gap Between Academia and the Real World

There is a well-known gap in the construction industry, universities and colleges produce graduates with strong theoretical foundations, but the transition into a live working environment can be daunting. Real projects do not follow textbook examples. Employers expect new QS professionals to contribute from Day One, and that requires a very different kind of knowledge: practical, applied, and industry-ready.

4

Core Training
Modules

37+

Detailed
Topics Covered

100%

Practical
Project-Based Focus

01 From Theory to Practice

This training takes everything you learned in your academic studies and translates it into the day-to-day reality of a QS role. Every topic is taught the way it is done on a construction site or in a QS office - not the way it appears in a textbook. You will work through real documents, real BOQs, real payment applications, and real variation scenarios.

02 Built for the Working Environment

Whether you are stepping into a Main Contractor, a Consultant firm, or a Client organisation, this training prepares you for all three. You will understand what is expected of you in each role, how to manage contractual obligations, how to communicate professionally, and how to add genuine value from the very first week of your employment.

03 Career-Ready from Day One

The final module takes preparation to the next level — with structured interview coaching and a live mock interview session conducted exactly as a real employer would do it. By the time you complete this training, you won't just know the theory — you will be ready, confident, and equipped to secure and succeed in your first QS role in the Gulf construction industry.



MODULE 01

GENERAL — Foundations of Quantity Surveying

14 Topics

01

Role of Quantity Surveyors

Understanding QS responsibilities in feasibility stage to post-contract financial management.

02

Projects in Gulf Countries

Overview of major construction project types across UAE, Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Kuwait, Bahrain & Oman including infrastructure, commercial and residential sectors.

03

Pre & Post Contract

Key stages of a project lifecycle — pre-contract tendering, BOQ preparation, and post-contract administration including interim valuations.

04

Design & Drawing Analysis

Reading and interpreting Concept, Schematic, and Detailed Drawings to extract quantity take-off data accurately.

05

Rough Estimation

Rapid cost estimating from drawings using elemental cost models and benchmark rates applicable.

06

Procurement & Tendering

Procurement strategies, tender processes and bid evaluation. Covers working arrangements: Traditional, Design & Build, and Management Contracting, understanding how each arrangement allocates risk and responsibility between client, contractor and consultant.

07

Types of Contract / Payment Mechanism

Lump Sum (Fixed Price), Remeasurement (Bill of Quantities), Cost Reimbursable, understanding how each payment mechanism works, when it is used, and its commercial implications for the QS.

08

Contract & Tender Documents

Preparing and reviewing tender packages, contract conditions, specifications, drawings, BOQ and Bonds and Insurances.

09

Conditions of Contract

In-depth coverage of FIDIC (Red, Yellow, Silver books), NEC3/4, and JCT contracts widely used in Gulf projects.

10

Standard Methods of Measurement

CESMM, NRM, and POMI - applying the correct measurement rules for civil, building, and MEP works.

11

Quantity Take-off & BOQ

Systematic quantity take-off for all building elements and preparation of a Bills of Quantities (BOQ).

12

BIM for Quantity Surveyors

Overview of Building Information Modelling - how QS professionals use BIM to extract quantities and manage costs.

13

Overview of RICS

Royal Institution of Chartered Surveyors - membership pathways, APC requirements, and its relevance in the construction market.

14

Essential QS Tools

Key software and tools used by Quantity Surveyors — estimating software, spreadsheets, BIM platforms, and document management.

This module focuses on the QS role from the Main Contractor's perspective - managing commercial risk, submitting payment applications, controlling subcontractor costs, and administering the contract to protect the contractor's commercial position throughout the project.

Payment Applications

- 01** Preparation and submission of monthly payment applications, interim valuations, measured works, preliminaries, and supporting documentation required by the client or contract administrator.

Variations

- 02** Managing contract variations from instruction to valuation, identifying scope changes, pricing additional/omitted works, and agreeing rates with the client's QS team.

Rate Analysis

- 03** Detailed breakdown of unit rates into labour, plant, material and overheads components. Building a competitive and transparent rate schedule for tender and variation assessment.

Final Accounts

- 04** Compiling the final account statement by reconciling all contract sums, variations, claims, and adjustments to reach an agreed final settlement with the client.

Cost Value Reconciliation

- 05** CVR compares the value of work certified (income) against the actual cost incurred by the contractor, a vital financial control tool used by Main Contractor QS teams to monitor project profitability and forecast the outturn cost.

Subcontractor Finalization

- 06** Preparing scope packages, sending subcontractor inquiries, receiving and comparing quotations, and finalizing subcontracts through systematic comparison sheets.

Subcontractor Invoices & Certification

- 07** Reviewing, certifying and processing subcontractor payment applications and invoices, ensuring compliance with the subcontract agreement and back-to-back payment terms.

Insurances & Bonds

- 08** Understanding the insurance and bond requirements typical of Gulf construction contracts - CAR, public liability, PII, plant insurance, tender bonds, performance bonds, and advance payment guarantees.

Correspondences & Emails

- 09** Professional contract correspondence management, notices, early warnings, extension of time claims, variation instructions, and maintaining a contractual audit trail.

This module focuses on the QS role from the Employer's (Client) and Consultant's perspective - managing project costs, certifying payments, approving variations, and ensuring value for money throughout the project lifecycle.

Cost Planning & Estimation

- 01** Developing detailed cost plans at each RIBA/design stage — concept, schematic, and detailed design. Preparing elemental cost estimates, updating and reconciling as design develops, and advising the client on budget sufficiency.

Payment Certificate

- 02** Reviewing and certifying contractor's interim payment applications — assessing measured works, variations, materials on site, and retention. Issuing Interim Payment Certificates (IPC) in accordance with contract conditions and programme.

Variations

- 03** Assessment and valuation of contractor's variation claims from the client/consultant side — reviewing entitlement, assessing fair rates, negotiating and agreeing the final variation account to protect the client's interests and budget.

Final Accounts

- 04** Managing the final account process on behalf of the client — reviewing the contractor's final account submission, reconciling all variations and claims, and reaching an agreed final settlement within the client's approved budget.

Cost Report

- 05** Preparing regular cost reports for client stakeholders — tracking committed costs, anticipated final costs, and cashflow forecasts. Cost reports give the client full visibility of project spend against the approved budget at every stage.

Value Engineering

- 06** Systematic analysis of project designs and specifications to identify cost savings without compromising quality or function. Facilitating VE workshops, preparing option studies, and advising clients on best-value decisions.

Provisional Sums & Prime Cost

- 07** Managing provisional sums and prime cost items — instructing the expenditure of PS allowances, obtaining competitive quotations for PC items, and adjusting the contract sum accordingly through formal instructions.



MODULE 04

FINAL INTERVIEW — Get Ready for Your Career

01 Interview Guidance & Job Placement

Practical preparation for QS job interviews in Gulf Countries. Learn how to present your experience, answer technical questions confidently, understand what employers look for, and position yourself as a strong candidate in the competitive Gulf construction market.

- ◆ How to structure and present your CV for Gulf employers
- ◆ Common technical interview questions with model answers
- ◆ Salary benchmarks and negotiation strategies in the Gulf
- ◆ Understanding the Gulf work culture and employer expectations
- ◆ How to demonstrate practical QS skills during an interview

02 Live Mock Interview Session

A full simulation of a real QS job interview conducted exactly as employers would do it — giving you the experience, confidence, and feedback you need before facing the real thing.

- ◆ Full mock interview conducted in real interview format
- ◆ Technical QS questions across all four modules of the course
- ◆ On-the-spot feedback and improvement coaching
- ◆ Body language, communication, and presentation tips
- ◆ Post-interview Q&A and personalized career advice



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